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Moving pages of a virtual whiteboard to breakout rooms associated with a video conference and combining the pages

Abstract

A system may instantiate a virtual whiteboard during a video conference controlled by a host device. The whiteboard may include a first page configured to output first visual content and a second page configured to output second visual content to displays of participant devices connected to the video conference. The system may move the first page to a first breakout room associated with the video conference and the second page to a second breakout room associated with the video conference. Access to the first page within the first breakout room may be limited to a first group of one or more of the participant devices connected to the first breakout room and the host device. Access to the second page within the second breakout room may be limited to a second group of one or more of the participant devices connected to the second breakout room and the host device.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION(S) (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/063,739, filed Dec. 9, 2022, the entire disclosure of which is hereby incorporated by reference.

FIELD

(1) This disclosure relates generally to video conferencing and, more specifically, to moving pages of a virtual whiteboard to breakout rooms associated with a video conference.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) This disclosure is best understood from the following detailed description when read in conjunction with the accompanying drawings. It is emphasized that, according to common practice, the various features of the drawings are not to-scale. On the contrary, the dimensions of the various features are arbitrarily expanded or reduced for clarity.

(2) FIG. 1 is a block diagram of an example of an electronic computing and communications system.

(3) FIG. 2 is a block diagram of an example internal configuration of a computing device of an electronic computing and communications system.

(4) FIG. 3 is a block diagram of an example of a software platform implemented by an electronic computing and communications system.

(5) FIG. 4 is a block diagram of an example of a system for moving pages of a virtual whiteboard to breakout rooms associated with a video conference.

(6) FIG. 5 is a block diagram of an example of a system in which a whiteboard is instantiated during a video conference controlled by a host device.

(7) FIG. 6 is a block diagram of an example of a system in which pages of a whiteboard are moved to breakout rooms associated with a video conference.

(8) FIG. 7 is an illustration of an example of a graphical user interface (GUI) including a notification that a page of a whiteboard is being used in a breakout room.

(9) FIG. 8 is an illustration of an example of a GUI including a notification that a page of a whiteboard has been generated in a breakout room.

(10) FIG. 9 is a block diagram of an example of a system in which pages of a whiteboard are combined in a main meeting room.

(11) FIG. 10 is an illustration of an example of a GUI for managing pages of a whiteboard moved to breakout rooms.

(12) FIG. 11 is a flowchart of an example of a technique for moving pages of a virtual whiteboard to breakout rooms associated with a video conference.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(13) Enterprise entities rely upon several modes of communication to support their operations, including telephone, email, internal messaging, and the like. These separate modes of communication have historically been implemented by service providers whose services are not integrated with one another. The disconnect between these services, in at least some cases, requires information to be manually passed by users from one service to the next. Furthermore, some services, such as telephony services, are traditionally delivered via on-premises systems, meaning that remote workers and those who are generally increasingly mobile may be unable to rely upon them. One type of system which addresses problems such as these includes a unified communications as a service (UCaaS) platform, which includes several communications services integrated over a network, such as the Internet, to deliver a complete communication experience regardless of physical location.

(14) Conferencing software, such as that of a conventional UCaaS platform, generally enables participants of a video conference to be moved into breakout rooms. A “breakout room” is a virtual meeting room that allows participants of a main meeting of a video conference to temporarily leave the main meeting and join a side meeting (e.g., breakout) of the video conference. A host can choose to split participants of the main meeting into these separate breakout rooms automatically or manually, or they can allow participants to select and enter breakout rooms on their own. Once the participants enter in the breakout rooms, they can use tools such as a virtual whiteboard to collaborate and share ideas. However, breakout rooms as enabled by conventional software are typically limited in the direction provided to participants in the breakout rooms. For example, when participants leave the main meeting for the breakout room, and are no longer with the host, the participants may have difficulty accomplishing the task they have been assigned because they are unclear about instructions that have been given to them, or what tools to use, or they do not know where to start. This may result in an inefficient use of time by the participants in the breakout rooms. Additionally, when the participants return from the breakout rooms to the main meeting to deliver the outcomes from the breakout rooms, an inefficient use of time in at least one breakout room can slow progress for the entire group in the main meeting. For example, when participants leave the main meeting and enter a breakout room, the participants might open a new, blank virtual whiteboard page and begin to add content. However, the participants might be unclear as to what content to add, and as a result, might be unprepared to bring desired content back to the entire group in the main meeting.

(15) Implementations of this disclosure address problems such as these by enabling a host device connected to a video conference to selectively assign pages of an online, interactive, virtual whiteboard to breakout rooms associated with the video conference for guiding participants in the breakout rooms. A server device executing conferencing software can instantiate the whiteboard during a video conference. Multiple participant devices may be connected to the video conference, including a host device controlling the video conference. The whiteboard can include multiple pages, such as a first page configured to output first visual content and a second page configured to output second visual content to displays of the participant devices. For example, the host and/or the participants can use virtual tools, such as draw, shape, and line tools, text editors, sticky notes, templates, image tools, erasers, and table editors, including with specified fonts, sizes, colors, widths and emphasis where applicable, to generate the visual content. In some implementations, one or more of the pages may be populated with visual content before the video conference begins. The server device can instantiate breakout rooms, such as a first breakout room and a second breakout room, and move the pages to the breakout rooms, such as the first page to the first breakout room and the second page to the second breakout room, during the video conference. In some implementations, the pages can be moved to the breakout rooms automatically based on labels or manually by receiving input from the host device. In some implementations, one or more pages may be generated in a breakout room. In some implementations, one or more pages may be moved from one breakout room to another. When ending the breakout rooms (e.g., at the end of the breakout sessions, when breakout participants re-join the main meeting), the pages from the breakout rooms can be combined so that changes made to the visual content in the breakout rooms are propagated to the whiteboard in the main meeting. As a result, when participants leave a main meeting for a breakout room, the participants can be guided by select pages of the whiteboard to improve the efficiency of the participants toward accomplishing the task assigned to the breakout room.

(16) To describe some implementations in greater detail, reference is first made to examples of hardware and software structures used to implement a system for moving pages of a virtual whiteboard to breakout rooms associated with a video conference. FIG. 1 is a block diagram of an example of an electronic computing and communications system **100**, which can be or include a distributed computing system (e.g., a client-server computing system), a cloud computing system, a

clustered computing system, or the like.

(17) The system **100** includes one or more customers, such as customers **102A** through **102B**, which may each be a public entity, private entity, or another corporate entity or individual that purchases or otherwise uses software services, such as of a UCaaS platform provider. Each customer can include one or more clients. For example, as shown and without limitation, the customer **102A** can include clients **104A** through **104B**, and the customer **102B** can include clients **104C** through **104D**. A customer can include a customer network or domain. For example, and without limitation, the clients **104A** through **104B** can be associated or communicate with a customer network or domain for the customer **102A** and the clients **104C** through **104D** can be associated or communicate with a customer network or domain for the customer **102B**.

(18) A client, such as one of the clients **104A** through **104D**, may be or otherwise refer to one or both of a client device or a client application. Where a client is or refers to a client device, the client can comprise a computing system, which can include one or more computing devices, such as a mobile phone, a tablet computer, a laptop computer, a notebook computer, a desktop computer, or another suitable computing device or combination of computing devices. Where a client instead is or refers to a client application, the client can be an instance of software running on a customer device (e.g., a client device or another device). In some implementations, a client can be implemented as a single physical unit or as a combination of physical units. In some implementations, a single physical unit can include multiple clients.

(19) The system **100** can include a number of customers and/or clients or can have a configuration of customers or clients different from that generally illustrated in FIG. 1. For example, and without limitation, the system **100** can include hundreds or thousands of customers, and at least some of the customers can include or be associated with a number of clients.

(20) The system **100** includes a datacenter **106**, which may include one or more servers. The datacenter **106** can represent a geographic location, which can include a facility, where the one or more servers are located. The system **100** can include a number of datacenters and servers or can include a configuration of datacenters and servers different from that generally illustrated in FIG. 1. For example, and without limitation, the system **100** can include tens of datacenters, and at least some of the datacenters can include hundreds or another suitable number of servers. In some implementations, the datacenter **106** can be associated or communicate with one or more datacenter networks or domains, which can include domains other than the customer domains for the customers **102A** through **102B**.

(21) The datacenter **106** includes servers used for implementing software services of a UCaaS platform. The datacenter **106** as generally illustrated includes an application server **108**, a database server **110**, and a telephony server **112**. The servers **108** through **112** can each be a computing system, which can include one or more computing devices, such as a desktop computer, a server computer, or another computer capable of operating as a server, or a combination thereof. A suitable number of each of the servers **108** through **112** can be implemented at the datacenter **106**. The UCaaS platform uses a multi-tenant architecture in which installations or instantiations of the servers **108** through **112** is shared amongst the customers **102A** through **102B**.

(22) In some implementations, one or more of the servers **108** through **112** can be a non-hardware server implemented on a physical device, such as a hardware server. In some implementations, a combination of two or more of the application server **108**, the database server **110**, and the telephony server **112** can be implemented as a single hardware server or as a single non-hardware server implemented on a single hardware server. In some implementations, the datacenter **106** can include servers other than or in addition to the servers **108** through **112**, for example, a media server, a proxy server, or a web server.

(23) The application server **108** runs web-based software services deliverable to a client, such as one of the clients **104A** through **104D**. As described above, the software services may be of a UCaaS platform. For example, the application server **108** can implement all or a portion of a

UCaaS platform, including conferencing software, messaging software, and/or other intra-party or inter-party communications software. The application server **108** may, for example, be or include a unitary Java Virtual Machine (JVM).

(24) In some implementations, the application server **108** can include an application node, which can be a process executed on the application server **108**. For example, and without limitation, the application node can be executed in order to deliver software services to a client, such as one of the clients **104A** through **104D**, as part of a software application. The application node can be implemented using processing threads, virtual machine instantiations, or other computing features of the application server **108**. In some such implementations, the application server **108** can include a suitable number of application nodes, depending upon a system load or other characteristics associated with the application server **108**. For example, and without limitation, the application server **108** can include two or more nodes forming a node cluster. In some such implementations, the application nodes implemented on a single application server **108** can run on different hardware servers.

(25) The database server **110** stores, manages, or otherwise provides data for delivering software services of the application server **108** to a client, such as one of the clients **104A** through **104D**. In particular, the database server **110** may implement one or more databases, tables, or other information sources suitable for use with a software application implemented using the application server **108**. The database server **110** may include a data storage unit accessible by software executed on the application server **108**. A database implemented by the database server **110** may be a relational database management system (RDBMS), an object database, an XML database, a configuration management database (CMDB), a management information base (MIB), one or more flat files, other suitable non-transient storage mechanisms, or a combination thereof. The system **100** can include one or more database servers, in which each database server can include one, two, three, or another suitable number of databases configured as or comprising a suitable database type or combination thereof.

(26) In some implementations, one or more databases, tables, other suitable information sources, or portions or combinations thereof may be stored, managed, or otherwise provided by one or more of the elements of the system **100** other than the database server **110**, for example, the client **104** or the application server **108**.

(27) The telephony server **112** enables network-based telephony and web communications from and to clients of a customer, such as the clients **104A** through **104B** for the customer **102A** or the clients **104C** through **104D** for the customer **102B**. Some or all of the clients **104A** through **104D** may be voice over internet protocol (VOIP)-enabled devices configured to send and receive calls over a network **114**. In particular, the telephony server **112** includes a session initiation protocol (SIP) zone and a web zone. The SIP zone enables a client of a customer, such as the customer **102A** or **102B**, to send and receive calls over the network **114** using SIP requests and responses. The web zone integrates telephony data with the application server **108** to enable telephony-based traffic access to software services run by the application server **108**. Given the combined functionality of the SIP zone and the web zone, the telephony server **112** may be or include a cloud-based private branch exchange (PBX) system.

(28) The SIP zone receives telephony traffic from a client of a customer and directs same to a destination device. The SIP zone may include one or more call switches for routing the telephony traffic. For example, to route a VOIP call from a first VOIP-enabled client of a customer to a second VOIP-enabled client of the same customer, the telephony server **112** may initiate a SIP transaction between a first client and the second client using a PBX for the customer. However, in another example, to route a VOIP call from a VOIP-enabled client of a customer to a client or non-client device (e.g., a desktop phone which is not configured for VOIP communication) which is not VOIP-enabled, the telephony server **112** may initiate a SIP transaction via a VOIP gateway that transmits the SIP signal to a public switched telephone network (PSTN) system for outbound

communication to the non-VOIP-enabled client or non-client phone. Hence, the telephony server **112** may include a PSTN system and may in some cases access an external PSTN system.

(29) The telephony server **112** includes one or more session border controllers (SBCs) for interfacing the SIP zone with one or more aspects external to the telephony server **112**. In particular, an SBC can act as an intermediary to transmit and receive SIP requests and responses between clients or non-client devices of a given customer with clients or non-client devices external to that customer. When incoming telephony traffic for delivery to a client of a customer, such as one of the clients **104A** through **104D**, originating from outside the telephony server **112** is received, a SBC receives the traffic and forwards it to a call switch for routing to the client.

(30) In some implementations, the telephony server **112**, via the SIP zone, may enable one or more forms of peering to a carrier or customer premise. For example, Internet peering to a customer premise may be enabled to ease the migration of the customer from a legacy provider to a service provider operating the telephony server **112**. In another example, private peering to a customer premise may be enabled to leverage a private connection terminating at one end at the telephony server **112** and at the other end at a computing aspect of the customer environment. In yet another example, carrier peering may be enabled to leverage a connection of a peered carrier to the telephony server **112**.

(31) In some such implementations, a SBC or telephony gateway within the customer environment may operate as an intermediary between the SBC of the telephony server **112** and a PSTN for a peered carrier. When an external SBC is first registered with the telephony server **112**, a call from a client can be routed through the SBC to a load balancer of the SIP zone, which directs the traffic to a call switch of the telephony server **112**. Thereafter, the SBC may be configured to communicate directly with the call switch.

(32) The web zone receives telephony traffic from a client of a customer, via the SIP zone, and directs same to the application server **108** via one or more Domain Name System (DNS) resolutions. For example, a first DNS within the web zone may process a request received via the SIP zone and then deliver the processed request to a web service which connects to a second DNS at or otherwise associated with the application server **108**. Once the second DNS resolves the request, it is delivered to the destination service at the application server **108**. The web zone may also include a database for authenticating access to a software application for telephony traffic processed within the SIP zone, for example, a softphone.

(33) The clients **104A** through **104D** communicate with the servers **108** through **112** of the datacenter **106** via the network **114**. The network **114** can be or include, for example, the Internet, a local area network (LAN), a wide area network (WAN), a virtual private network (VPN), or another public or private means of electronic computer communication capable of transferring data between a client and one or more servers. In some implementations, a client can connect to the network **114** via a communal connection point, link, or path, or using a distinct connection point, link, or path. For example, a connection point, link, or path can be wired, wireless, use other communications technologies, or a combination thereof.

(34) The network **114**, the datacenter **106**, or another element, or combination of elements, of the system **100** can include network hardware such as routers, switches, other network devices, or combinations thereof. For example, the datacenter **106** can include a load balancer **116** for routing traffic from the network **114** to various servers associated with the datacenter **106**. The load balancer **116** can route, or direct, computing communications traffic, such as signals or messages, to respective elements of the datacenter **106**. For example, the load balancer **116** can operate as a proxy, or reverse proxy, for a service, such as a service provided to one or more remote clients, such as one or more of the clients **104A** through **104D**, by the application server **108**, the telephony server **112**, and/or another server. Routing functions of the load balancer **116** can be configured directly or via a DNS. The load balancer **116** can coordinate requests from remote clients and can simplify client access by masking the internal configuration of the datacenter **106** from the remote

clients.

(35) In some implementations, the load balancer **116** can operate as a firewall, allowing or preventing communications based on configuration settings. Although the load balancer **116** is depicted in FIG. **1** as being within the datacenter **106**, in some implementations, the load balancer **116** can instead be located outside of the datacenter **106**, for example, when providing global routing for multiple datacenters. In some implementations, load balancers can be included both within and outside of the datacenter **106**. In some implementations, the load balancer **116** can be omitted.

(36) FIG. **2** is a block diagram of an example internal configuration of a computing device **200** of an electronic computing and communications system. In one configuration, the computing device **200** may implement one or more of the client **104**, the application server **108**, the database server **110**, or the telephony server **112** of the system **100** shown in FIG. **1**.

(37) The computing device **200** includes components or units, such as a processor **202**, a memory **204**, a bus **206**, a power source **208**, peripherals **210**, a user interface **212**, a network interface **214**, other suitable components, or a combination thereof. One or more of the memory **204**, the power source **208**, the peripherals **210**, the user interface **212**, or the network interface **214** can communicate with the processor **202** via the bus **206**.

(38) The processor **202** is a central processing unit, such as a microprocessor, and can include single or multiple processors having single or multiple processing cores. Alternatively, the processor **202** can include another type of device, or multiple devices, configured for manipulating or processing information. For example, the processor **202** can include multiple processors interconnected in one or more manners, including hardwired or networked. The operations of the processor **202** can be distributed across multiple devices or units that can be coupled directly or across a local area or other suitable type of network. The processor **202** can include a cache, or cache memory, for local storage of operating data or instructions.

(39) The memory **204** includes one or more memory components, which may each be volatile memory or non-volatile memory. For example, the volatile memory can be random access memory (RAM) (e.g., a DRAM module, such as DDR DRAM). In another example, the non-volatile memory of the memory **204** can be a disk drive, a solid state drive, flash memory, or phase-change memory. In some implementations, the memory **204** can be distributed across multiple devices. For example, the memory **204** can include network-based memory or memory in multiple clients or servers performing the operations of those multiple devices.

(40) The memory **204** can include data for immediate access by the processor **202**. For example, the memory **204** can include executable instructions **216**, application data **218**, and an operating system **220**. The executable instructions **216** can include one or more application programs, which can be loaded or copied, in whole or in part, from non-volatile memory to volatile memory to be executed by the processor **202**. For example, the executable instructions **216** can include instructions for performing some or all of the techniques of this disclosure. The application data **218** can include user data, database data (e.g., database catalogs or dictionaries), or the like. In some implementations, the application data **218** can include functional programs, such as a web browser, a web server, a database server, another program, or a combination thereof. The operating system **220** can be, for example, Microsoft Windows®, Mac OS X®, or Linux®; an operating system for a mobile device, such as a smartphone or tablet device; or an operating system for a non-mobile device, such as a mainframe computer.

(41) The power source **208** provides power to the computing device **200**. For example, the power source **208** can be an interface to an external power distribution system. In another example, the power source **208** can be a battery, such as where the computing device **200** is a mobile device or is otherwise configured to operate independently of an external power distribution system. In some implementations, the computing device **200** may include or otherwise use multiple power sources. In some such implementations, the power source **208** can be a backup battery.

- (42) The peripherals **210** includes one or more sensors, detectors, or other devices configured for monitoring the computing device **200** or the environment around the computing device **200**. For example, the peripherals **210** can include a geolocation component, such as a global positioning system location unit. In another example, the peripherals can include a temperature sensor for measuring temperatures of components of the computing device **200**, such as the processor **202**. In some implementations, the computing device **200** can omit the peripherals **210**.
- (43) The user interface **212** includes one or more input interfaces and/or output interfaces. An input interface may, for example, be a positional input device, such as a mouse, touchpad, touchscreen, or the like; a keyboard; or another suitable human or machine interface device. An output interface may, for example, be a display, such as a liquid crystal display, a cathode-ray tube, a light emitting diode display, virtual reality display, or other suitable display.
- (44) The network interface **214** provides a connection or link to a network (e.g., the network **114** shown in FIG. 1). The network interface **214** can be a wired network interface or a wireless network interface. The computing device **200** can communicate with other devices via the network interface **214** using one or more network protocols, such as using Ethernet, transmission control protocol (TCP), internet protocol (IP), power line communication, an IEEE 802.X protocol (e.g., Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, or ZigBee), infrared, visible light, general packet radio service (GPRS), global system for mobile communications (GSM), code-division multiple access (CDMA), Z-Wave, another protocol, or a combination thereof.
- (45) FIG. 3 is a block diagram of an example of a software platform **300** implemented by an electronic computing and communications system, for example, the system **100** shown in FIG. 1. The software platform **300** is a UCaaS platform accessible by clients of a customer of a UCaaS platform provider, for example, the clients **104A** through **104B** of the customer **102A** or the clients **104C** through **104D** of the customer **102B** shown in FIG. 1. The software platform **300** may be a multi-tenant platform instantiated using one or more servers at one or more datacenters including, for example, the application server **108**, the database server **110**, and the telephony server **112** of the datacenter **106** shown in FIG. 1.
- (46) The software platform **300** includes software services accessible using one or more clients. For example, a customer **302** as shown includes four clients—a desk phone **304**, a computer **306**, a mobile device **308**, and a shared device **310**. The desk phone **304** is a desktop unit configured to at least send and receive calls and includes an input device for receiving a telephone number or extension to dial to and an output device for outputting audio and/or video for a call in progress. The computer **306** is a desktop, laptop, or tablet computer including an input device for receiving some form of user input and an output device for outputting information in an audio and/or visual format. The mobile device **308** is a smartphone, wearable device, or other mobile computing aspect including an input device for receiving some form of user input and an output device for outputting information in an audio and/or visual format. The desk phone **304**, the computer **306**, and the mobile device **308** may generally be considered personal devices configured for use by a single user. The shared device **310** is a desk phone, a computer, a mobile device, or a different device which may instead be configured for use by multiple specified or unspecified users.
- (47) Each of the clients **304** through **310** includes or runs on a computing device configured to access at least a portion of the software platform **300**. In some implementations, the customer **302** may include additional clients not shown. For example, the customer **302** may include multiple clients of one or more client types (e.g., multiple desk phones or multiple computers) and/or one or more clients of a client type not shown in FIG. 3 (e.g., wearable devices or televisions other than as shared devices). For example, the customer **302** may have tens or hundreds of desk phones, computers, mobile devices, and/or shared devices.
- (48) The software services of the software platform **300** generally relate to communications tools but are in no way limited in scope. As shown, the software services of the software platform **300** include telephony software **312**, conferencing software **314**, messaging software **316**, and other

software **318**. Some or all of the software **312** through **318** uses customer configurations **320** specific to the customer **302**. The customer configurations **320** may, for example, be data stored within a database or other data store at a database server, such as the database server **110** shown in FIG. **1**.

(49) The telephony software **312** enables telephony traffic between ones of the clients **304** through **310** and other telephony-enabled devices, which may be other ones of the clients **304** through **310**, other VOIP-enabled clients of the customer **302**, non-VOIP-enabled devices of the customer **302**, VOIP-enabled clients of another customer, non-VOIP-enabled devices of another customer, or other VOIP-enabled clients or non-VOIP-enabled devices. Calls sent or received using the telephony software **312** may, for example, be sent or received using the desk phone **304**, a softphone running on the computer **306**, a mobile application running on the mobile device **308**, or using the shared device **310** that includes telephony features.

(50) The telephony software **312** further enables phones that do not include a client application to connect to other software services of the software platform **300**. For example, the telephony software **312** may receive and process calls from phones not associated with the customer **302** to route that telephony traffic to one or more of the conferencing software **314**, the messaging software **316**, or the other software **318**.

(51) The conferencing software **314** enables audio, video, and/or other forms of conferences between multiple participants, such as to facilitate a conference between those participants. In some cases, the participants may all be physically present within a single location, for example, a conference room, in which the conferencing software **314** may facilitate a conference between only those participants and using one or more clients within the conference room. In some cases, one or more participants may be physically present within a single location and one or more other participants may be remote, in which the conferencing software **314** may facilitate a conference between all of those participants using one or more clients within the conference room and one or more remote clients. In some cases, the participants may all be remote, in which the conferencing software **314** may facilitate a conference between the participants using different clients for the participants. The conferencing software **314** can include functionality for hosting, presenting scheduling, joining, or otherwise participating in a conference. The conferencing software **314** may further include functionality for recording some or all of a conference and/or documenting a transcript for the conference.

(52) The messaging software **316** enables instant messaging, unified messaging, and other types of messaging communications between multiple devices, such as to facilitate a chat or other virtual conversation between users of those devices. The unified messaging functionality of the messaging software **316** may, for example, refer to email messaging which includes a voicemail transcription service delivered in email format.

(53) The other software **318** enables other functionality of the software platform **300**. Examples of the other software **318** include, but are not limited to, device management software, resource provisioning and deployment software, administrative software, third party integration software, and the like. In one particular example, the other software **318** can include virtual whiteboard software, for example, software for moving pages of a virtual whiteboard to breakout rooms associated with a video conference. In some such cases, the conferencing software **314** may include the other software **318**.

(54) The software **312** through **318** may be implemented using one or more servers, for example, of a datacenter such as the datacenter **106** shown in FIG. **1**. For example, one or more of the software **312** through **318** may be implemented using an application server, a database server, and/or a telephony server, such as the servers **108** through **112** shown in FIG. **1**. In another example, one or more of the software **312** through **318** may be implemented using servers not shown in FIG. **1**, for example, a meeting server, a web server, or another server. In yet another example, one or more of the software **312** through **318** may be implemented using one or more of the servers **108** through

112 and one or more other servers. The software **312** through **318** may be implemented by different servers or by the same server.

(55) Features of the software services of the software platform **300** may be integrated with one another to provide a unified experience for users. For example, the messaging software **316** may include a user interface element configured to initiate a call with another user of the customer **302**. In another example, the telephony software **312** may include functionality for elevating a telephone call to a conference. In yet another example, the conferencing software **314** may include functionality for sending and receiving instant messages between participants and/or other users of the customer **302**. In yet another example, the conferencing software **314** may include functionality for file sharing between participants and/or other users of the customer **302**. In some implementations, some, or all, of the software **312** through **318** may be combined into a single software application run on clients of the customer, such as one or more of the clients **304** through **310**.

(56) FIG. 4 is a block diagram of an example of a system **400** for moving pages of a virtual whiteboard **422** to breakout rooms associated with a video conference **402**. The system **400** may include one or more participant devices that can be used by participants of the video conference **402**, such as participant devices **410A** to **410D**. The system **400** may also include a host device that can be used by a host of the video conference **402**, such as the host device **412**. The participant devices **410A** to **410D** can access the video conference **402** (e.g., join as participants), and the host device **412** can control the video conference **402** (e.g., host the meeting). Each of the participant devices **410A** to **410D** and the host device **412** may be a client device such as one of the clients **104A** through **104D** shown in FIG. 1 or **304** through **310** shown in FIG. 3. Although four participant devices **410A** to **410D** are shown and described by example, other numbers of participant devices may be used with the system **400**. A participant device such as the participant devices **410A** to **410D** or the host device **412** may execute software (e.g., client-side conferencing software, which could, for example, be via a client application or a web application used to connect to a conference implemented using server-side conferencing software, such as the conferencing software **314** shown in FIG. 3) and may connect to a server device **420**. The server device **420** may execute software (e.g., server-side conferencing software, such as the conferencing software **314**) to support the video conference **402** between participants using the participant devices **410A** to **410D**. For example, the server device **420** could be a server at the datacenter **106** shown in FIG. 1, such as the application server **108** or the telephony server **112**.

(57) The host device **410** can move the participants using the participant devices **410A** to **410D** from a main meeting room to one or more breakout rooms. The host device **410** can split the participants using the participant devices **410A** to **410D** (e.g., from the main meeting room) into these separate breakout rooms automatically or manually, or the host device **410** can allow the participants using the participant devices **410A** to **410D** to select and enter breakout rooms on their own. For example, the host device **410** can move the participants using the participant devices **410A** and **410B** into a first breakout room **404** and move the participants using the participant devices **410C** and **410D** into a second breakout room **406**. Once the participants enter in the breakout rooms, they can use tools such as an online, interactive, virtual whiteboard **422** to collaborate and share ideas.

(58) The host device **410** can selectively assign pages of the whiteboard **422** to the first breakout room **404** and the second breakout room **406** associated with the video conference **402**. The host device **410** can assign the pages to the breakout rooms for guiding the participants using the participant devices **410A** to **410D** in the breakout rooms. For example, the host device **410** can control the server device **420**, executing the conferencing software (e.g., the server-side conferencing software, such as the conferencing software **314**), to instantiate the whiteboard **422** (e.g., via whiteboard software, such as the other software **318**) during the video conference **402**. The whiteboard **422** can include multiple pages, such as a first page configured to output first

visual content and a second page configured to output second visual content to displays of the participant devices **410A** to **410D**. For example, the host and/or the participants can use virtual tools, such as draw, shape, and line tools, text editors, sticky notes, templates, image tools, erasers, and table editors, including with specified fonts, sizes, colors, widths and emphasis where applicable, to generate the visual content.

(59) The host device **410** can control the server device **420** to instantiate the breakout rooms, such as the first breakout room **404** and the second breakout room **406**. The host device **410** can assign participants to the breakout rooms, automatically or manually, such as the participants using the participant devices **410A** and **410B** assigned to the first breakout room **404**, and the participants using the participant devices **410C** and **410D** assigned to the second breakout room **406**. The host device **410** can selectively move the pages of the whiteboard **422** to the breakout rooms, such as the first page to the first breakout room **404** and the second page to the second breakout room **406**, during the video conference **402**. This may enable the participants using the participant devices **410A** and **410B** to use the first page when in the first breakout room **404**, and the participants using the participant devices **410C** and **410D** to use the second page when in the second breakout room **406**. For example, access to the first page in the first breakout room **404** may be limited to the participant devices that are connected to the first breakout room **404** in a first group (e.g., the participants using the participant devices **410A** and **410B**) and the host device **410**. Access to the second page in the second breakout room **406** may be limited to the participant devices that are connected to the second breakout room **406** in a second group (e.g., the participants using the participant devices **410C** and **410D**) and the host device **410**.

(60) In the breakout rooms (e.g., the first breakout room **404** and the second breakout room **406**), the participants using the participant devices (e.g., the participant devices **410A** to **410D**) can access the pages of the whiteboard **422** moved into their respective breakout rooms, such as by viewing and/or editing the visual content. For example, while in the breakout rooms, the participants using the participant devices **410A** and **410B** can access the first page moved into the first breakout room **404**, but not the second page moved into the second breakout room **406**. Similarly, while in the breakout rooms, the participants using the participant devices **410C** and **410D** can access the second page moved into the second breakout room **406**, but not the first page moved into the first breakout room **404**. Further, the participants joining the breakout rooms, via the participant devices being connected thereto, may communicate with one another in their respective breakout rooms, such as by speaking to one another using cameras and microphones, chatting with one another using keyboards and screens, and seeing video feeds of one another in user tiles using cameras and screens. For example, the participants using the participant devices **410A** and **410B** can communicate with one another in the first breakout room **404**, but may not communicate with the participants using the participant devices **410C** and **410D** in the second breakout room **406**. Similarly, the participants using the participant devices **410C** and **410D** can communicate with one another in the second breakout room **406**, but may not communicate with the participants using the participant devices **410A** and **410B** in the first breakout room **404**. As a result, when the participants using the participant devices **410A** to **410D** leave the main meeting for a breakout room, the participants can be guided by the select pages of the whiteboard **422** to improve their efficiency in the breakout rooms.

(61) The host can join a breakout room (e.g., the first breakout room **404** or the second breakout room **406**) as another participant, with the host device **410** being connected thereto, or can remain in the main meeting room and not join the breakout room. When the host remains in the main meeting room, the participants do not see the host as a participant in their breakout rooms. However, the host using the host device **410** can still access the pages in the breakout rooms, such as by viewing and/or editing the visual contents. For example, the host using the host device **410** can access the first page in the first breakout room **404**, and the second page in the second breakout room **406**, without joining either the first breakout room **404** or the second breakout room **406** as a

participant.

(62) When ending the first breakout room **404** and/or the second breakout room **406** (e.g., at the end of the breakout sessions, when the participants using the participant devices **410A** to **410D** reconnect to the main meeting of the video conference **402**, such as when side video conferences associated with the breakout rooms have closed or terminated, so that the participant devices **410A** to **410D** can no longer connect to them), the pages from the breakout rooms can be combined in the main meeting. This may enable changes made to the visual content, in the breakout rooms, to be propagated to the whiteboard **422** in the main meeting.

(63) FIG. 5 is a block diagram of an example of a system **500** in which a whiteboard **522** is instantiated during a video conference controlled by a host device. The system **500** can be executed using computing devices, such as the systems, hardware, and software described with respect to FIGS. 1-4. For example, the whiteboard **522** could be the whiteboard **422** shown in FIG. 4. In the system **500**, a host using the host device (e.g., the host device **412**, shown in FIG. 5 as “H”) can instantiate a main meeting room and multiple breakout rooms associated with the main meeting room, such as a main meeting room **502**, a first breakout room **504**, and a second breakout room **506**. Each instantiated room may include a session identifier or address that allows conferencing software, such as the conferencing software **314**, to organize the rooms, individually or in groups, and to associate or link the breakout rooms as sub-rooms to the main meeting room **502**. Initially, the host can join the main meeting room **502** and admit participants (e.g., the participants using the participant devices **410A** to **410D**, shown in FIG. 5 as “P1,” “P2,” “P3,” and “P4,” respectively) to join the main meeting room **502**. For example, the host could be a teacher and the participants could be students in a virtual classroom, or the host could be an administrator and the participants could be collaborators in a virtual conference room. The participants, including the host, may communicate with one another in the main meeting room **502** with the host controlling the video conference.

(64) The whiteboard **522** may include one or more pages, such as a first page **524** and a second page **526**. Each page may include a page identifier that allows the whiteboard software (e.g., the other software **318**) to organize the pages and to associate or link the pages as sub-whiteboards to the whiteboard **522**. The pages may be configured to output visual content to displays of the host device and the participant devices connected to the video conference. For example, the first page **524** may be configured to output first visual content (e.g., shown as WBp1 in FIG. 5), and the second page **526** may be configured to output second visual content (e.g., shown as WBp2 in FIG. 5). This may enable the participants to communicate with one another via virtual whiteboarding. In some implementations, one or more of the pages may be populated with visual content before the video conference begins. For example, the host can prepare the first visual content associated with the first page **524** and/or the second visual content associated with the second page **526** in advance of the video conference (e.g., before the host and the participants join the video conference). The host can then load the first page **524** with the first visual content, and/or the second page **526** with the second visual content, during the video conference. This may enable the host to save time by creating the pages with the visual content before the video conference begins.

(65) FIG. 6 is a block diagram of an example of the system **500** in which pages of the whiteboard **522** are moved to the breakout rooms associated with the video conference. For example, the host device can selectively assign the first page **524** to the first breakout room **504** and the second page to the second breakout room **506**, causing the first page **524** to move to the first breakout room **504** and the second page to move to the second breakout room **506**. In some implementations, the host may provide input, via the host device, to assign the pages to the breakout rooms. For example, the host may select, through a GUI, an assignment of the first page **524** to the first breakout room **504**, and the second page **526** to the second breakout room **506**. In some implementations, the pages may be automatically assigned to the breakout rooms. For example, in one case, the first page **524** may be randomly assigned to the first breakout room **504**, and the second page **526** may be

randomly assigned to the second breakout room **506**, by the whiteboard software (e.g., the other software **318**). In some implementations, the pages may be assigned to the breakout rooms based on labels corresponding to the pages. For example, the first page **524** could have a first label (e.g., “math_problem”), the second page **526** could have a second label (e.g., “science_problem”), the first breakout room **504** could have a third label (e.g., “math_breakout_session”), and the second breakout room **506** could have a fourth label (e.g., “science_breakout_session”). The first page **524** may be assigned to the first breakout room **504** based on a match between the first label and the third label (e.g., “math”), and the second page **526** may be assigned to the second breakout room **506** based on a match between the second label and the fourth label (e.g., “science”).

(66) The participants (e.g., **P1** to **P4**) may also be moved to the breakout rooms associated with the video conference. For example, the host device can selectively assign **P1** and **P2** (e.g., a first group) to the first breakout room **504** and **P3** and **P4** (e.g., a second group) to the second breakout room **506**, causing **P1** and **P2** to move to the first breakout room **504** and **P3** and **P4** to move to the second breakout room **506**. In some implementations, the host may provide input, via the host device, to assign the participants to the breakout rooms. For example, the host may select, through the GUI, an assignment of **P1** and **P2** to the first breakout room **504**, and **P3** and **P4** to the second breakout room **506**. In some implementations, the participants may manually move to the breakout rooms. For example, **P1** and **P2** may individually select to leave the main meeting room **502** and join the first breakout room **504**, and **P3** and **P4** may individually select to leave the main meeting room **502** and join the second breakout room **506**. In some implementations, the participants may be automatically assigned to the breakout rooms. For example, in one case, **P1** and **P2** may be randomly assigned to the first breakout room **504**, and **P3** and **P4** may be randomly assigned to the second breakout room **506**, by the conferencing software (e.g., the conferencing software **314**). In another case, the participants may be assigned to the breakout rooms based on labels corresponding to the participants (e.g., names). For example, **P1** and **P2** may be assigned to the first breakout room **504** based on an earlier alphabetical order of their names, and **P3** and **P4** may be assigned to the second breakout room **506** based on a later alphabetical order of their names. In some implementations, the participants may be linked to the pages of the whiteboard **522**, such as by corresponding labels, and the participants may be assigned to the breakout rooms based on assigning the pages to the breakout rooms. For example, **P1** and **P2** may be linked to the first page **524**, and the **P3** and **P4** may be linked to the second page **526**. Moving the first page **524** to the first breakout room **504** may cause **P1** and **P2** to be assigned to the first breakout room **504**, and moving the second page **526** to the second breakout room **506** may cause **P3** and **P4** to be assigned to the second breakout room **506**.

(67) In the breakout rooms (e.g., the first breakout room **504** and the second breakout room **506**), the participants using the participant devices (e.g., **P1** to **P4**) can access the pages of the whiteboard **522** moved into their respective breakout rooms, such as by viewing and/or editing the visual content. For example, **P1** and **P2** can access the first page **524** moved into the first breakout room **504**, but not the second page **526** moved into the second breakout room **506**. Similarly, **P3** and **P4** can access the second page **526** moved into the second breakout room **506**, but not the first page **524** moved into the first breakout room **504**. The participants can use virtual tools, such as draw, shape, and line tools, text editors, sticky notes, templates, image tools, erasers, and table editors, including with specified fonts, sizes, colors, widths and emphasis where applicable, to edit the visual content. The host can join a breakout room as another participant, or can remain in the main meeting room **502** and not join the breakout room as shown in FIG. **6**. When the host remains in the main meeting room **502**, the participants do not see the host as a participant in their breakout rooms. However, the host can still access the pages in the breakout rooms, such as by viewing and/or editing the visual contents. For example, the host can access the first page **524** in the first breakout room **504**, and the second page **526** in the second breakout room **506**, without joining either the first breakout room **504** or the second breakout room **506** as a participant.

(68) In some implementations, the level of access by the participants to the pages in the breakout rooms may be limited. For example, access to the first page **524** by the first group, including **P1** and **P2**, may be limited to view access (e.g., the participants in the first group may only view the first visual content), while access to the second page **526** by the second group, including **P3** and **P4**, may include edit access (e.g., the participants in the second group may edit the second visual content). In some implementations, one or more of the participants in a group may be given greater access to the visual content (e.g., edit access) than other participants in the group (e.g., restricted to view access). For example, in the first group, **P1** may be designed as a sub-host using a sub-host device **530**, and may therefore be given greater access (e.g., edit access) than **P2** (e.g., restricted to view access). In the second group, **P3** may be designed as a sub-host using a sub-host device **532**, and may therefore be given greater access (e.g., edit access) than **P4** (e.g., restricted to view access). A participant may be assigned as a sub-host manually (e.g., the host may provide input, via the host device) or automatically (e.g., randomly by the whiteboard software, or based on labels).

(69) In the breakout rooms, the participants may edit the pages of the whiteboard **522** based on the access that is given. For example, **P1** and/or **P2** may edit the first page **524** to change the first visual content (e.g., shown as **WBp1** in FIG. 5) in the first breakout room **504**, and **P3** and/or **P4** may edit the second page **526** to change the second visual content (e.g., **WBp2** in FIG. 5) in the second breakout room **506**. The host can access the pages in the breakout rooms, including by viewing the changes to the visual content made by the participants, from the main meeting room **502** (e.g., without joining a breakout room). In some implementations, when a participant accesses a page in a breakout room (e.g., viewing or editing), a notification may be transmitted to the host via the host device, indicating such access. For example, with additional reference to FIG. 7, a GUI **700** could be displayed to the host device. The GUI **700** may include a notification that a page of a whiteboard (e.g., the first page **524**) is being used in a breakout room (e.g., **P1** or **P2** accessing the first page **524**). The notification may include a link **702** to enable the host to join the breakout room that is accessing the page (e.g., the link may enable the host device to connect to the breakout room using the page, such as the first breakout room **504**).

(70) In some implementations, one or more pages may be moved from one breakout room to another. For example, the first page **524** could be moved from the first breakout room **504** to the second breakout room **506**, and the second page **526** could be moved from the second breakout room **506** to the first breakout room **504**. The pages could be moved between the breakout rooms by the host device or by a participant device (e.g., when a level of access associated with the participant device enables such movement). In some implementations, the one or more pages may be moved from one breakout room to another automatically, such as moving the pages based on the expiration of a timer.

(71) Referring again to FIG. 6, in some implementations, participants in a breakout room, or the host in the main meeting room **502**, may instantiate a new page in a breakout room or the main meeting room **502**. The new page may include a page identifier that allows the whiteboard software (e.g., the other software **318**) to organize the page and to associate or link the page as a sub-whiteboard to the whiteboard **522**. For example, **P3** or **P4** in the second breakout room **506**, or the host in the main meeting room **502**, may instantiate a third page **528** in the second breakout room. The third page **528** may be linked to the whiteboard **522** by linking to the second page **526**. In some implementations, when a participant instantiates a new page in a breakout room, a notification may be transmitted to the host via the host device, indicating such instantiation. For example, with additional reference to FIG. 8, a GUI **800** could be displayed to the host device. The GUI **800** may include a notification that a page of a whiteboard (e.g., the first page **524**) has been generated in a breakout room. The notification may include a link **802** to enable the host to join the breakout room that generated the page (e.g., the link may enable the host device to connect to the breakout room that instantiated the page, such as the second breakout room **506**).

(72) FIG. 9 is a block diagram of an example of the system **500** in which pages of the whiteboard

522 are combined in the main meeting room **502** (e.g., merged). For example, when ending the breakout rooms (e.g., the first breakout room **504** and the second breakout room **506**, ending at the end of the breakout sessions, such as when **P1** to **P4** re-join the main meeting room **502**, and side video conferences associated with the first breakout room **504** and the second breakout room **506** have closed or terminated), the pages from the breakout rooms (e.g., the first page **524**, the second page **526**, and the third page **528**) can be combined in the whiteboard **522** in the main meeting room **502**. Further, the pages can be combined in the whiteboard **522** so that changes made to the visual content in the breakout rooms (e.g., the first visual content associated with the first page **524**, the second visual content associated with the second page **526**, and a third visual content associated with the third page **528**) are propagated to the whiteboard **522**.

(73) In some implementations, a page from a breakout room may be combined in the main meeting room **502** when the page is closed in the breakout room, including when the breakout room remains open. For example, the first page **524** from the first breakout room **504** may be combined in the main meeting room **502** when the first page **524** is closed in the first breakout room **504**, including when the first breakout room **504** remains open, and one or more participants (e.g., **P1** or **P2**) remain in the first breakout room **504**. In some implementations, a page from a breakout room may be combined in the main meeting room **502** when the page is saved in the breakout room, including when the page remains open and in use in the breakout room. For example, the first page **524** from the first breakout room **504** may be combined in the main meeting room **502** when the first page **524** is saved by a participant (e.g., **P1** or **P2**) in the first breakout room **504**. In some implementations, a page from a breakout room may be combined in the main meeting room **502** when the breakout room is closed, including when another breakout room remains open. For example, the first page **524** from the first breakout room **504** may be combined in the main meeting room **502** when the first breakout room **504** is closed, including when the second breakout room **506** remains open. In some implementations, a page from a breakout room may be combined in the main meeting room **502** when all pages in breakout rooms, and/or all breakout rooms, have closed. For example, the first page **524** from the first breakout room **504** may be combined in the main meeting room **502** when the first page **524** and the second page **526** have closed, and/or when the first breakout room **504** and the second breakout room **506** have closed.

(74) FIG. **10** is an illustration of an example of a GUI **1000** for managing pages of the whiteboard **522** moved to breakout rooms. For example, the GUI **1000** could be output to a display of a host device (e.g., the host device **412**) connected to the video conference (e.g., the video conference **402**). The host, using the host device, can use the GUI **1000** to access pages moved to the breakout rooms, such as the first page **524** moved to the first breakout room **504** and the second page **526** moved to the second breakout room **506**. The host, using the host device, can also use the GUI **1000** to access pages instantiated in breakout rooms, such as the third page **528** moved instantiated in the second breakout room **506**. This may enable the host to access the pages in the breakout rooms without joining a breakout room (e.g., from a main meeting room, such as the main meeting room **502**). For example, through the GUI **1000**, the host can identify the first page **524** moved to the first breakout room **504**, the second page **526** moved to the second breakout room **506**, and the third page **528** instantiated in the second breakout room **506**. Also, through the GUI **1000**, the host may view changes to the visual content associated with the pages, made by the participants in the breakout rooms, such as changes to the first visual content (e.g., shown as **WBp1'** in FIG. **10**) in the first breakout room **504**, and changes to the second visual content (e.g., shown as **WBp2'** in FIG. **10**) in the second breakout room **506**.

(75) The GUI **1000** may include breakout participant indicators indicating the participants in the breakout rooms, such as a first breakout participant indicator **1002** and a second breakout participant indicator **1004**. For example, through the GUI **1000**, and the first breakout participant indicator **1002**, the host can identify **P1** and **P2** in the first breakout room **504**. Through the GUI **1000** and the second breakout participant indicator **1004**, the host can identify **P3** and **P4** in the

second breakout room **506**.

(76) The GUI **1000** may include a new page selection **1006** for instantiating a new page of the whiteboard **522**. Once instantiated, the host can populate the new page with visual content, such as by using whiteboard tools **1008**. For example, the whiteboard tools **1008** may include virtual tools, such as draw, shape, and line tools, text editors, sticky notes, templates, image tools, erasers, and table editors, including with specified fonts, sizes, colors, widths and emphasis where applicable, to generate the visual content. The new page can be assigned and moved to a breakout room (e.g., the first breakout room **504** and/or the second breakout room **506**), like the first page **524** moved to the first breakout room **504** and the second page **526** moved to the second breakout room **506**.

(77) In some implementations, the GUI **1000** may enable the host to populate one or more pages with visual content before the video conference begins. For example, in advance of the video conference (e.g., before the host and the participants join the video conference), the host can use the new page selection **1006** to instantiate new pages, and use the whiteboard tools **1008** to generate visual content associated with the pages. For example, the pages could be the first page **524** and the second page **526**. The host can then load the pages with the first visual content during the video conference. This may enable the host to save time by creating the pages with the visual content before the video conference begins.

(78) To further describe some implementations in greater detail, reference is next made to examples of techniques which may be performed by or using a system for moving pages of a virtual whiteboard to breakout rooms associated with a video conference. FIG. **11** is a flowchart of an example of a technique **1100** for moving pages of a virtual whiteboard. The technique **1100** can be executed using computing devices, such as the systems, hardware, and software described with respect to FIGS. **1-10**. The technique **1100** can be performed, for example, by executing a machine-readable program or other computer-executable instructions, such as routines, instructions, programs, or other code. The steps, or operations, of the technique **1100** or another technique, method, process, or algorithm described in connection with the implementations disclosed herein can be implemented directly in hardware, firmware, software executed by hardware, circuitry, or a combination thereof.

(79) For simplicity of explanation, the technique **1100** is depicted and described herein as a series of steps or operations. However, the steps or operations in accordance with this disclosure can occur in various orders and/or concurrently. Additionally, other steps or operations not presented and described herein may be used. Furthermore, not all illustrated steps or operations may be required to implement a technique in accordance with the disclosed subject matter.

(80) At an optional step **1102**, a device (e.g., the host device **412**, connected to the server device **420**), may populate a first page (e.g., the first page **524**) with first visual content and/or a second page (e.g., the second page **526**) with second visual content before a video conference (e.g., the video conference **402**) begins. The first page and the second page may be associated with a digital whiteboard (e.g., the whiteboard **422** or the whiteboard **522**). For example, a host can prepare the first visual content associated with the first page and/or the second visual content associated with the second page in advance of the video conference. The host could use the GUI **1000** to populate the first page with the first visual content and/or populate the second page with the second visual content, such as by using whiteboard tools (e.g., the whiteboard tools **1008**).

(81) At **1104**, the device may instantiate the whiteboard, including the first page and the second page, during a video conference controlled by the host device. For example, the device may receive the first page populated with the first visual content and/or the second page populated with the second visual content when populated before the video conference begins at step **1102**. The video conference may include a first breakout room (e.g., the first breakout room **404**, or the first breakout room **504**) and a second breakout room (e.g., the second breakout room **406**, or the second breakout room **506**). The host can load the first page with the first visual content, and/or the second page with the second visual content, from step **1102** if already prepared. Alternatively, the host can

prepare the first visual content associated with the first page and the second visual content associated with the second page following instantiation of the whiteboard and the pages during the video conference. The first page may be configured to output the first visual content and the second page may be configured to output second visual content to displays of participant devices connected to the video conference.

(82) At **1106**, the device may move the first page to the first breakout room associated with the video conference and move the second page to the second breakout room associated with the video conference. In some implementations, the pages may be automatically assigned to the breakout rooms. For example, in one case, the first page may be randomly assigned to the first breakout room, and the second page may be randomly assigned to the second breakout room, by the whiteboard software (e.g., the other software **318**). In some implementations, the pages may be assigned to the breakout rooms based on labels corresponding to the pages. For example, the first page could have a first label, the second page could have a second label, the first breakout room could have a third label, and the second breakout room could have a fourth label. The first page may be assigned to the first breakout room based on a match between the first label and the third label, and the second page may be assigned to the second breakout room based on a match between the second label and the fourth label.

(83) At **1108**, the device may enable a first group of participants (e.g., the participants using the participant devices **410A** and **410B**, or **P1** and **P2**) in the first breakout room, and the host, to access the first page moved to the first breakout room, and may enable a second group of participants (e.g., the participants using the participant devices **410C** and **410D**, or **P3** and **P4**) in the second breakout room, and the host, to access the second page moved to the second breakout room. Access to the first page (e.g., the first page **524**) within the first breakout room (e.g., the first breakout room **404**, or the first breakout room **504**) may be limited to the first group of the participant devices (e.g., the participant devices **410A** and **410B**) connected to the first breakout room, and the host device, and access to the second page (e.g., the second page **526**) within the second breakout room (e.g., the second breakout room **406**, or the second breakout room **506**) may be limited to the second group of participant devices (e.g., the participant devices **410C** and **410D**) connected to the second breakout room, and the host device (e.g., the host device **412**). After the first page is moved to the first breakout room and the second page is moved to the second breakout room, the host device may access the first page within the video conference without connecting to the first breakout room (e.g., without the host joining the first breakout room) and access the second page within the video conference without connecting to the second breakout room (e.g., without the host joining the second breakout room).

(84) At **1110**, the device may combine the first page from the first breakout room with the second page from the second breakout room. For example, the first page and the second page may be combined when the first breakout room and the second breakout room end (e.g., at the end of the breakout sessions, such as when the participants re-join the main meeting room, and the participants device re-connect thereto). The pages can be combined in the whiteboard so that changes made to the visual content in the breakout rooms (e.g., the first visual content associated with the first page, the second visual content associated with the second page, and a third visual content associated with the third page) are propagated to the whiteboard.

(85) Some implementations may include a method that includes: instantiating a virtual whiteboard during a video conference controlled by a host device, the whiteboard including a first page configured to output first visual content and a second page configured to output second visual content to displays of participant devices connected to the video conference; and moving the first page to a first breakout room associated with the video conference and the second page to a second breakout room associated with the video conference, wherein access to the first page within the first breakout room is limited to a first group of one or more of the participant devices connected to the first breakout room and the host device, and wherein access to the second page within the

second breakout room is limited to a second group of one or more of the participant devices connected to the second breakout room and the host device. In some implementations, the method includes populating at least one of the first page with the first visual content or the second page with the second visual content before the video conference begins. In some implementations, after the first page is moved to the first breakout room and the second page is moved to the second breakout room, the host device is configured to access the first page within the video conference without connecting to the first breakout room and access the second page within the video conference without connecting to the second breakout room. In some implementations, the method includes assigning, based on input from the host device, the first page to the first breakout room and the second page to the second breakout room. In some implementations, the method includes assigning the first page to the first breakout room based on a first label corresponding to the first page and assigning the second page to the second breakout room based on a second label corresponding to the second page. In some implementations, the method includes ending the first breakout room and the second breakout room; and combining the first page from the first breakout room with the second page from the second breakout room. In some implementations, access to the first page by the first group is limited to view access, and the method includes granting edit access to a sub-host device in the first group, wherein the edit access enables the sub-host device to change the first visual content. In some implementations, the method includes instantiating a third page of the whiteboard in at least one of the first breakout room or the second breakout room; and transmitting a notification to the host device indicating instantiation of the third page.

(86) Some implementations may include an apparatus that includes a memory; and a processor configured to execute instructions stored in the memory to: instantiate a virtual whiteboard during a video conference controlled by a host device, the whiteboard including a first page configured to output first visual content and a second page configured to output second visual content to displays of participant devices connected to the video conference; and move the first page to a first breakout room associated with the video conference and the second page to a second breakout room associated with the video conference, wherein access to the first page within the first breakout room is limited to a first group of one or more of the participant devices connected to the first breakout room and the host device, and wherein access to the second page within the second breakout room is limited to a second group of one or more of the participant devices connected to the second breakout room and the host device. In some implementations, the processor is further configured to execute instructions stored in the memory to receive at least one of the first page populated with the first visual content or the second page populated with the second visual content before the video conference begins. In some implementations, the processor is further configured to execute instructions stored in the memory to enable the host device to access the first page while connected to a main meeting room of the video conference without the host device connecting to the first breakout room. In some implementations, the processor is further configured to execute instructions stored in the memory to assign, randomly, the first page to the first breakout room and the second page to the second breakout room. In some implementations, the processor is further configured to execute instructions stored in the memory to move the first page from the first breakout room and the second page from the second breakout room to a main meeting room of the video conference. In some implementations, the processor is further configured to execute instructions stored in the memory to grant edit access to a first participant device in the first group for editing the first page and view access to other participant devices in the first group to limit the other participant devices to viewing. In some implementations, the processor is further configured to execute instructions stored in the memory to transmit a notification to the host device indicating at least one of viewing or editing of the first page in the first breakout room.

(87) Some implementations may include a non-transitory computer readable medium storing instructions operable to cause one or more processors to perform operations that include: instantiating a virtual whiteboard during a video conference controlled by a host device, the

whiteboard including a first page configured to output first visual content and a second page configured to output second visual content to displays of participant devices connected to the video conference; and moving the first page to a first breakout room associated with the video conference and the second page to a second breakout room associated with the video conference, wherein access to the first page within the first breakout room is limited to a first group of one or more of the participant devices connected to the first breakout room and the host device, and wherein access to the second page within the second breakout room is limited to a second group of one or more of the participant devices connected to the second breakout room and the host device. In some implementations, the operations include moving, by the host device, the first page to the second breakout room and the second page to the first breakout room. In some implementations, the operations include generating a third page in a main meeting room of the video conference; and moving the third page to the at least one of the first breakout room or the second breakout room. In some implementations, the operations include enabling the host device to edit the first page in the first breakout room while the host device is connected to a main meeting room of the video conference. In some implementations, the operations include enabling the host device, from a main meeting room of the video conference, to view one or more edits to the first page in the first breakout room and view one or more edits to the second page in the second breakout room without the host device connecting to the first breakout room or the second breakout room.

(88) The implementations of this disclosure can be described in terms of functional block components and various processing operations. Such functional block components can be realized by a number of hardware or software components that perform the specified functions. For example, the disclosed implementations can employ various integrated circuit components (e.g., memory elements, processing elements, logic elements, look-up tables, and the like), which can carry out a variety of functions under the control of one or more microprocessors or other control devices. Similarly, where the elements of the disclosed implementations are implemented using software programming or software elements, the systems and techniques can be implemented with a programming or scripting language, such as C, C++, Java, JavaScript, assembler, or the like, with the various algorithms being implemented with a combination of data structures, objects, processes, routines, or other programming elements.

(89) Functional aspects can be implemented in algorithms that execute on one or more processors. Furthermore, the implementations of the systems and techniques disclosed herein could employ a number of conventional techniques for electronics configuration, signal processing or control, data processing, and the like. The words “mechanism” and “component” are used broadly and are not limited to mechanical or physical implementations, but can include software routines in conjunction with processors, etc. Likewise, the terms “system” or “tool” as used herein and in the figures, but in any event based on their context, may be understood as corresponding to a functional unit implemented using software, hardware (e.g., an integrated circuit, such as an ASIC), or a combination of software and hardware. In certain contexts, such systems or mechanisms may be understood to be a processor-implemented software system or processor-implemented software mechanism that is part of or callable by an executable program, which may itself be wholly or partly composed of such linked systems or mechanisms.

(90) Implementations or portions of implementations of the above disclosure can take the form of a computer program product accessible from, for example, a computer-usable or computer-readable medium. A computer-usable or computer-readable medium can be a device that can, for example, tangibly contain, store, communicate, or transport a program or data structure for use by or in connection with a processor. The medium can be, for example, an electronic, magnetic, optical, electromagnetic, or semiconductor device.

(91) Other suitable mediums are also available. Such computer-usable or computer-readable media can be referred to as non-transitory memory or media and can include volatile memory or non-volatile memory that can change over time. The quality of memory or media being non-transitory

refers to such memory or media storing data for some period of time or otherwise based on device power or a device power cycle. A memory of an apparatus described herein, unless otherwise specified, does not have to be physically contained by the apparatus, but is one that can be accessed remotely by the apparatus, and does not have to be contiguous with other memory that might be physically contained by the apparatus.

(92) While the disclosure has been described in connection with certain implementations, it is to be understood that the disclosure is not to be limited to the disclosed implementations but, on the contrary, is intended to cover various modifications and equivalent arrangements included within the scope of the appended claims, which scope is to be accorded the broadest interpretation so as to encompass all such modifications and equivalent structures as is permitted under the law.

Claims

1. A method, comprising: instantiating a virtual whiteboard during a video conference, the virtual whiteboard including a first page and a second page configured for display to participant devices connected to the video conference; moving the first page to a first breakout room associated with the video conference and the second page to a second breakout room associated with the video conference, wherein access to the first breakout room is limited to a first group of one or more of the participant devices connected to the first breakout room, wherein access to the second breakout room is limited to a second group of one or more of the participant devices connected to the second breakout room; combining the first page with the second page to form combined pages; propagating the combined pages to the virtual whiteboard in a main meeting room so that the combined pages are displayed to the participant devices connected to the video conference; accessing, with a host device, the first page within the first breakout room without connecting to the first breakout room; accessing, with the host device, the second page within the second breakout room without connecting to the second breakout room; and generating a notification, to the host device, that the first page in the first breakout room and/or the second page in the second breakout room are being accessed or edited.
2. The method of claim 1, further comprising: populating at least one of the first page or the second page before the video conference begins.
3. The method of claim 1, further comprising: merging the first breakout room and the second breakout room.
4. The method of claim 1, further comprising: assigning the first page to the first breakout room based on a first label corresponding to the first page and assigning the second page to the second breakout room based on a second label corresponding to the second page.
5. The method of claim 1, further comprising: ending the first breakout room and the second breakout room; and combining the first page from the first breakout room with the second page from the second breakout room.
6. The method of claim 1, wherein access to the first page by the first group is limited to view access, the method further comprising: granting edit access to a sub-host device in the first group, wherein the edit access enables the sub-host device to change a first visual content.
7. The method of claim 1, further comprising: instantiating a third page of the virtual whiteboard in at least one of the first breakout room or the second breakout room; and transmitting a notification to a host device indicating instantiation of the third page.
8. The method of claim 1, further comprising: a graphical user interface configured to manage and view changes to the first page in the first breakout room and the second page in the second breakout room without the host device joining the first breakout room and the second breakout room.
9. An apparatus, comprising: a memory; and a processor configured to execute instructions stored in the memory to: instantiate a virtual whiteboard during a video conference, the virtual whiteboard

including a first page and a second page to displays of participant devices connected to the video conference; move the first page to a first breakout room associated with the video conference and the second page to a second breakout room associated with the video conference, wherein access to the first breakout room is limited to a first group of one or more of the participant devices connected to the first breakout room, and wherein access to the second breakout room is limited to a second group of one or more of the participant devices connected to the second breakout room; combine the first page with the second page to form combined pages; propagate the combined pages to the virtual whiteboard in a main meeting room so that the combined pages are displayed to the participant devices connected to the video conference; enable a host device to access the first page while connected to a main meeting room of the video conference without the host device connecting to the first breakout room; and generate a notification, to the host device, that the first page in the first breakout room and/or the second page in the second breakout room are being accessed or edited.

10. The apparatus of claim 9, wherein the processor is further configured to execute instructions stored in the memory to: receive at least one of the first page or the second page populated before the video conference begins.

11. The apparatus of claim 9, wherein the processor is further configured to execute instructions stored in the memory to: assign, randomly, the first page to the first breakout room and the second page to the second breakout room.

12. The apparatus of claim 9, wherein the processor is further configured to execute instructions stored in the memory to: move the first page from the first breakout room and the second page from the second breakout room to a main meeting room of the video conference.

13. The apparatus of claim 9, wherein the processor is further configured to execute instructions stored in the memory to: grant edit access to a first participant device in the first group for editing the first page and view access to other participant devices in the first group to limit the other participant devices to viewing.

14. The apparatus of claim 9, wherein the processor is further configured to execute instructions stored in the memory to: transmit a notification to a host device indicating at least one of viewing or editing of the first page in the first breakout room.

15. The apparatus of claim 9, further comprising: a graphical user interface configured to manage and view changes to the first page in the first breakout room and the second page in the second breakout room without the host device joining the first breakout room and the second breakout room.

16. A non-transitory computer readable medium storing instructions operable to cause one or more processors to perform operations comprising: instantiating a virtual whiteboard during a video conference, the virtual whiteboard including a first page and a second page to displays of participant devices connected to the video conference; moving the first page to a first breakout room associated with the video conference and the second page to a second breakout room associated with the video conference, wherein access to the first breakout room is limited to a first group of one or more of the participant devices connected to the first breakout room, and wherein access to the second breakout room is limited to a second group of one or more of the participant devices connected to the second breakout room; combining the first page with the second page to form combined pages; propagating the combined pages to the virtual whiteboard in a main meeting room so that the combined pages are displayed to the participant devices connected to the video conference; enabling a host device to edit the first page in the first breakout room while the host device is connected to a main meeting room of the video conference; and generating a notification, to the host device, that the first page in the first breakout room and/or the second page in the second breakout room are being accessed or edited.

17. The non-transitory computer readable medium storing instructions of claim 16, the operations further comprising: moving, by a host device, the first page to the second breakout room and the

second page to the first breakout room.

18. The non-transitory computer readable medium storing instructions of claim 16, the operations further comprising: generating a third page in a main meeting room of the video conference; and moving the third page to at least one of the first breakout room or the second breakout room.

19. The non-transitory computer readable medium storing instructions of claim 16, the operations further comprising: enabling a host device, from a main meeting room of the video conference, to view one or more edits to the first page in the first breakout room and view one or more edits to the second page in the second breakout room without the host device connecting to the first breakout room or the second breakout room.

20. The non-transitory computer readable medium storing instructions of claim 16, further comprising: a graphical user interface configured to manage and view changes to the first page in the first breakout room and the second page in the second breakout room without the host device joining the first breakout room and the second breakout room.
